

Google open sources end-to-end encrypted email service project

Google has decided to open source its experimental end-to-end encryption email system. Called E2EMail, this internal project by the search giant promises to deliver a secured, email communication solution.



E2EMail offers advanced security measures to prevent snooping. The email service is designed for end users as well as enterprise customers, and provides optimum security and privacy.

A large number of communication services have implemented encryption after Edward Snowden's disclosure about NSA's spying activities. However, not every email service out there offers end-to-end encryption. This is the reason Google wants to magnify the reach of end-to-end encryption to a wider audience through its E2EMail.

Based on JavaScript crypto library, E2EMail integrates OpenPGP into Gmail using a Chrome extension and keeps all clear text of the message body exclusive to the email client. The initial model uses a barebones central key server for testing. But Google is also planning to deploy its Key Transparency to improve the security of the service further.

"Key Transparency delivers a solid, scalable and thus practical solution, replacing the problematic web-of-trust model traditionally used with PGP," Google's security and privacy engineering team comprising KB Sriram, Eduardo Vela Nava and Stephan Somogyi said in a blog post.

The E2EMail code is available for access through a GitHub repository. The open source release comes with Apache License version 2.0.

The Mad Gadget flaw has led to some serious attacks in the past. It enabled a hacker to gain access to the San Francisco Municipal Railway system last November. And it caused a PayPal vulnerability that was discovered in December 2015.

Android Studio 2.3 will make it easy to build new apps

Google has upgraded Android Studio to version 2.3. The latest release is designed to make it easy for developers to build new Android apps. "We are most excited about the quality improvements in Android Studio 2.3, but you will find a small set of new features in this release that integrate into each phase of your development flow," wrote Android product manager Jamal Eason, in a blog post.

One of the major changes that Android Studio 2.3 includes is the improved version of the Run action. You just need to hit the Run action button from the toolbar to automatically restart the app and view the changes in your code. Also, there is a new Apply Changes action that swaps the code while your app keeps running on the screen.

Eason mentioned that the Android team has significantly changed the underlying implementation to deliver a more reliable experience. The startup lag for instant Run-enabled apps has also been eliminated to improve the performance on the IDE.

GitHub launches hosted service to serve enterprises with cloud

More than nine years after being a one-stop code repository solution for the open source community, GitHub is finally taking a sharp turn to support enterprises. The new development is a hosted service by the company to let some large companies opt for a cloud solution to store their code.



GitHub previously had three workflow plans, namely, Developer, Team and Business. But keeping the fast adoption of the cloud in mind, the San Francisco, California based company has expanded its Business package with the hosted version. The new offering brings SAML single sign-on, automated provisioning and deprovisioning, real-time support on business days and guaranteed uptime. All this comes at a monthly charge of US\$ 21 per user.

BlackArch Linux adds 50 new ethical hacking tools

BlackArch Linux OS has announced a new ISO that includes 50 new tools for ethical hacking. With the latest development, the Linux distribution now comes with over 1700 ethical hacking and penetration testing tools pre-installed.

The BlackArch Linux 2017-03-01 release is based on Linux kernel 4.9.11. The latest ISO brings a fresh range of tools that eases penetration testing and ethical hacking. Additionally, the distribution has a new installer version 0.3.3 and an in-house BlackArch build. The BlackArch Linux team has also improved dependencies and installation scripts in the latest build.

Notably, while Arch Linux has stopped supporting 32-bit machines, the latest build by BlackArch Linux offers both 32-bit and 64-bit ISOs. BlackArch Linux also has a 64-bit OVA image that can be used in VirtualBox, QEMU and VMware virtualisation software. You can download the BlackArch Linux 2017-03-01 build from its official website. Existing users simply need to get the latest update on their system by running the 'sudo pacman -Syu' command in the terminal or virtual console.

Raspberry Pi Zero W debuts with Wi-Fi and Bluetooth

After successfully selling over twelve million units of Raspberry Pi over the past five years, computer engineer Eben Upton has brought the Raspberry Pi Zero W to